

1. Darwin Core Vocabulary Maintenance Interest Group Charter

1. Convenor

John Wieczorek

2. Core Members

- Peter Desmet
- Markus Doering
- Tim Robertson
- Steve Baskauf
- Paula Zermoglio

3. Motivation

This group is established to meet the requirements in Section 2.1 of the [TDWG Vocabulary Maintenance Specification](#): to maintain the Darwin Core vocabulary.

4. Becoming Involved

The task group welcomes the participation of individuals who have a vested interest in maintaining the stability and interoperability of Darwin Core. We need people with interest and experience in vocabulary creation, people who are well versed in best practices for metadata documentation, and people with technical data management skills. If you are interested in participating in the group, please contact the convener or a core member.

5. History/Context

The Darwin Core vocabulary has existed in various forms since 1998 and was ratified as a TDWG Standard in 2009. Its terms are widely used in biodiversity metadata transfer and storage. The Darwin Core vocabulary can be used to describe biodiversity resources through fielded text, XML, and RDF. For more information, see Wieczorek et al. 2012. *Darwin Core: An Evolving Community-Developed Biodiversity Data Standard* <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0029715> .

6. Summary

The Darwin Core Vocabulary Maintenance Interest Group is responsible for maintaining the various components of the Darwin Core Standard. That includes managing suggested changes to the vocabulary, providing usage guidelines and examples, and ensuring the preservation and stability of metadata related to

components of the standard. Interest Group members have a strong interest in ensuring the stability and interoperability of the vocabulary.

7. Resources

- Introduction to Darwin Core with links to usage guides: <http://rs.tdwg.org/dwc/index.htm>
- A summary of Darwin Core terms: <http://rs.tdwg.org/dwc/terms/index.htm>
- Darwin Core terms wiki: https://terms.tdwg.org/wiki/Darwin_Core
- Darwin Core GitHub repository: <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc>